The intent of the `generateText` function is to generate text based on the provided input. It encapsulates the high-level functionality of text generation.

The model parameter in this call is the actual AI model as returned by the Vercel AI SDK provider specification, which allows abstracting the individual providers and the interface with them. For example, one model could be `gpt3.5-turbo` from OpenAI and another one could be `claude-3-opus` from Anthropic. You can easily swap models based on your needs. Section 1.3 goes deeper into this feature if you want to take a quick look at how it works.

What's the benefit of using this approach compared to directly calling the OpenAI endpoint? If you recall from when I talked about the separation of concerns concept earlier, the action associated with the `generateText` function is the specific API call or model invocation that generates the text. In this case, it communicates internally with the AI model specified by the model parameter to generate text. By separating the intent (generating text) from the action (invoking the AI model), the code becomes more modular and flexible.

Alternative usage

You can also use the `generateText` function with a simpler structure, like this:

```
const result = await generateText({
 system: "I'm happy to assist you in any way I can.
➥How can I be of service today?",
 prompt: text,
 model: model('gpt-4o'),
 maxTokens: 512,
});
```

In this alternative usage, we're directly specifying the model and providing a single prompt instead of a series of messages.

Now let's integrate this function into the API route handler.

IncrementaliIntegration: Updating the route handler

As part of our incremental integration strategy, we will first update our existing API route handler to use the Vercel AI SDK. This allows us to test the new functionality without changing any of our frontend code.

> **NOTE** The source code for the following example is available at https://github.com/Generative-AI-Web-Apps/Code/tree/main/ch03/chat-vercel-ai.

Follow these general steps to integrate the Vercel AI SDK and use `generateText`:

1. *Review the installation instructions*—To start using the Vercel AI SDK in our project, we need to install it following the recommended approach for our environment. Since the Vercel AI SDK is a JavaScript library available via Node Package